Teacher Wu Kuan | Exam at a Glance #18 — A Log Just Asks “What Power?”

English lecture notes · YouTube Short sg1uRGsn_Ck

1. The trap question

What does $\log_2 8$ mean?

2. The method

- log_b N = “b to what power gives N?”
- $\log_2 8 = 3$ because $2^3 = 8$; log 1000 = 3 because $10^3 = 1000$.
- Fractions give negative powers: $\log_2(1/8) = -3$.

3. Parent check method

Have your child read every log aloud as a question: “2 to what power is 8?”

Practice

1. $\log_2 16$
2. $\log_3 81$
3. log 10000 (base 10)
4. $\log_2 (1/8)$
5. $\log_5 25 + \log_2 32$

Answers

1. 4
2. 4
3. 4
4. −3
5. 7 (2 + 5)

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